

Portfolio Morning Brief — Sunday, August 9, 2026

Covering news from August 2-9, 2026, across the full portfolio/watchlist. Positions treated as live exposure. Links inline on factual claims. Sections: Top of the stack → What matters by group → Probably noise → Time-sensitive / positions watch → Follow-up questions.

1. Top of the stack

The CRML Aug 21 \$12.50 call is the one position that needs a decision this week. Critical Metals rallied roughly 30% on the week — up ~15.5% on Monday alone on rare-earth policy optimism ([TS2](#)) — but at ~\$7.19 as of Friday ([Yahoo](#)) the stock is still ~42% below the \$12.50 strike with roughly nine trading days to expiry. It would take a further ~74% move to reach the money. The only dated in-window catalyst is the Tanbreez pilot-plant Stage 1 completion, scheduled for August ([StockTitan](#)); the European Lithium scheme meetings land at or after expiry ([Proactive](#)). Realistic base case: the call expires worthless. If any salvage value exists on a policy-headline spike, this week is the time to harvest it.

The macro regime whipsawed in your favor — for now. Friday's July payrolls showed employers unexpectedly *cutting* 23,000 jobs versus ~+80k expected, with >100k of downward revisions ([AP via Washington Times](#)). In a world where Fed Chair Warsh has been openly signaling readiness to *hike* in September ([TechTimes](#)), the miss cut September hike odds from ~58% to ~42% ([Trading Economics](#)) and produced the strongest S&P week since April — +3.6%, first-ever close above 7,700; Nasdaq +5.2%, Nvidia +11.6% ([CNBC](#), [Seeking Alpha](#)). Good for the long NQ/ES futures; but Wednesday's CPI (Aug 12) lands the same day as the 10-year auction, and PPI (Aug 13) the same day as the 30-year — the entire hike debate re-opens mid-week. Your long-end exposure (WNU6, IEF) sits directly in the blast radius: the 30-year is at 5.19% and +13bp on the month ([Forbes](#)).

Korean memory took a 2-day beating that was sentiment, not fundamentals. SK Hynix fell ~13-15% over Thursday-Friday (to ₩1,422,000) on SanDisk's weak guidance, Iran risk-off, and a second Korea Exchange "overheating" designation in a month ([TradingKey](#), [Benzinga](#)); Samsung Electronics fell ~6% in sympathy. Nothing company-specific broke: Hynix's Q2 was a record (76% operating margin) and 2027 HBM contract talks are underway from a position of strength ([Seoul Economic Daily](#)); meanwhile US-listed semis rebounded hard into the weekend with record ETF inflows ([Yahoo](#)). The divergence between Korean-listed and US-listed semis in the same week is notable. Nvidia's Aug 26 print is the sector's next verdict ([Finance Calendar](#)).

Silver ripped ~11% to ~\$64/oz — the biggest positive P&L week in the book's commodity sleeve. Wednesday +4% on Treasury Secretary Bessent's Hormuz-reopening comments, Friday +4.2% after the payrolls shock hit the dollar ([Benzinga](#), [FXLeaders](#)). SLV took ~\$229M of 5-day inflows ([ETFdb](#)); SIL levers the move; Vizsla added an execution-phase hire (President, Mexico) for Panuco ([TipRanks](#)).

Brent fell >7% on Hormuz-reopening odds — a direct hit to the energy sleeve's tailwind. Iran and Oman drafted a deal to reopen the Strait (closed since June); Brent dipped below \$80 mid-week before settling ~\$83.55 after Iran struck targets in the Strait on Thursday ([Fortune](#), [Trading Economics](#)). ENI/Repsol/Total all earn on crisis pricing (Eni realized \$96.50/bbl on liquids in Q2 — [Yahoo](#)), so ratification would compress the earnings base their raised guidance and buybacks are built on. All three are actively buying back stock, which cushions it.

2. What matters, by group

Rails / shipping / financials

Allied Gold (AAUC CN) — the week's best fundamental print in this group. Q2 EPS of \$0.44 beat by ~52%; H1 production 193k+ oz on track for guidance; Kurmuk (Ethiopia) is on the verge of first gold; balance sheet holds \$192M cash, ~\$500M pro forma with Zijin's C\$417M placement at C\$32.55 ([GlobeNewswire](#), [Aug 5](#)). Context: the full Zijin takeover was terminated July 29 and replaced by that placement ([SEC 6-K](#)) — the position is now a standalone-operator story again, not a take-out.

Brighthouse (BHF) is now purely a merger-arb clock. Q2 adjusted EPS of \$4.45 lagged consensus ([Business Wire](#)), but the important disclosure was that every closing condition for Aquarian's \$70/share deal is satisfied except insurance approvals in Delaware, New York, and Massachusetts, with a Sept 6 outside date that auto-extends to Dec 6 ([StockTitan 8-K](#)). Fundamentals are secondary; the spread to \$70 and the three state regulators are what matter.

UP/NS merger: quiet week, loud next step. No new filings Aug 2-9; the railroads submitted the STB's required supplemental information July 27 and the proceeding sits in abeyance until the Board issues a new procedural schedule ([STB](#), [UP](#)). That schedule order could drop any day and will move both names. UNP drifted to ~\$258.52, a four-week low ([Trading Economics](#)) — drift, not signal. Note UNP's raised \$1.42 dividend has an Aug 31 record date ([UNP IR](#)).

ZIM is pinned to Hapag-Lloyd's \$35 cash deal ([ZIM IR](#)); Q2 lands Aug 19 with no call ([PRNewswire](#)) — watch for an interim dividend declaration. **Alti Global (ALTI)** reports Monday Aug 10 after close ([Business Wire](#)). **Ceconomy (CEC GY)** stays pinned by JD.com's €4.60 offer — Austria, Spain, and the EU foreign-subsidies review are the remaining gates, closing pushed to H2 ([ad-hoc-news](#)).

Luxury / consumer / Korea / autos / energy / alternatives

Ferrari (RACE) was the sleeve's clear positive. Post-beat momentum continued: Berenberg to €384, Equita and Citi (€347) also raised; the stock led the FTSE MIB on Monday ([Borsa Italiana](#)). The raised FY26 guide (adj. EPS ≥€9.68, personalization >20% of car revenue) is the anchor ([CNBC](#)). Exor benefits at NAV level.

Inter Parfums (IPAR/ITP FP) was the sleeve's mild negative. Q2 sales beat (\$341M) but EPS missed by a penny and "reaffirmed" FY guidance sits below Street (\$1.48bn vs \$1.50bn revenue)

([GlobeNewswire](#)); Paris-listed ITP drifted lower in sympathy (−2.6% Friday, [ad-hoc-news](#)). Balance sheet is fine (\$211M cash, inventories −12%); this is a guidance-credibility story into the holiday sell-in.

LVMH/Dior: nothing new, and that's the problem. Only administrative filings this week ([buyback disclosure](#)); the stock sits near €480, close to the bottom of its 52-week range and −30% YTD ([Investing.com](#)) after July's soft fashion-recovery print. No catalyst until October Q3 revenue. **Puig** got a BNP Exane upgrade to Outperform (PT €18) in the post-H1 wave ([Investing.com](#)); **Coty** is silent ahead of its make-or-break FY print Aug 20.

Korea: the rout above; the holdcos followed. SK Inc. (034730) fell with the hynix chain and reports Aug 19 ([Investing.com](#)); Samsung C&T (028260) was quiet. LG Chem (051910) and LG Energy Solution (373220) had no new news — LGES's live thesis remains the ESS/AI-datacenter pivot (Q2 ESS revenue up 4.6x y/y, Q3 guided +20% q/q — [Energy-Storage.News](#)). Samsung's FMS unveiling of zHBM and 400+ layer NAND ([Samsung Newsroom](#)) plus reports it could take the #1 HBM spot in 2027 ([Sammy Fans](#)) keep the HBM4 share-shift story alive — that's the real medium-term question inside the Samsung/Hynix pair.

Naspers/Prosus: everything hinges on Wednesday. Routine buybacks continued ([Ghost Mail](#)) and the EU cleared sole control of eMAG ([Romania Insider](#)), but Tencent's Q2 on Aug 12 is the NAV event ([IG preview](#)).

Japan telcos both delivered. KDDI Q1 adjusted operating profit +21.1% with lower churn, stock near 52-week highs ([Investing.com](#)); NTT posted record quarterly revenue ¥3.62tn with operating profit ~¥10bn above consensus and a new CFO hinting guidance is conservative ([BigGo](#)). Both thesis-confirming for defensive compounders.

Pershing complex: circle Thursday Aug 13. PSH NAV was \$77.10 at July 31 with buybacks running weekly ([PSH RNS](#)). On Aug 13: PSH semiannual report, PSUS semiannual, Pershing Square Inc. (PS) Q2 earnings, and an Ackman/Ryan Israel public Q&A — all in one day ([Yahoo](#)). PSUS still trades ~\$37.83 versus its \$50 April IPO — the discount debate is unresolved ([StockAnalysis](#), [Seeking Alpha](#)).

Blackstone had a heavy deployment week and the stock responded (+~7%). Financing lined up for the A\$36bn HSBC Australian mortgage book (largest home-loan portfolio deal ever, [Blackstone](#), [Bloomberg](#)); Kuwait pipeline JV and AI data-center credit push continue ([Yahoo](#)); TD Cowen raised its target to \$154. **Partners Group** kept deploying too — AVK data-centre power infrastructure, exclusive talks on Aroma-Zone ([Simply Wall St](#)) — with the real test at Sept 1 interims. **IPRV** rides both passively (note: it appears twice in your list — it's the same cross-listed fund, [iShares](#)).

Wendel (MF FP) banked a real event: IHS Towers shareholders approved MTN's \$6.2bn take-private on Aug 4, de-risking ~\$535m of proceeds to Wendel at H2 closing ([Techeconomy](#)) — on top of H1 showing asset-management fees +56% ([GlobeNewswire](#)).

Energy: strategy vs. tape. TotalEnergies bought Shell's entire European onshore renewables business (500MW operating + 3.5GW pipeline) while simultaneously recycling 50% of a €1.8bn

developed portfolio to KKR ([TotalEnergies](#)) — capital-light growth that distinguishes it from retreating peers. Repsol launched a fresh €500m buyback Aug 3 ([The Corner](#)); Eni's buyback passed €1.07bn cumulative ([Eni](#)). All three trade off the Hormuz headline risk described up top.

Autos were quiet but carry unresolved overhangs: VW's late-July revenue-guidance cut (China weakness, tariffs — [Investing.com](#)) and Porsche AG's restructuring ("Future Package," 5,000 more job cuts by 2035 — [Porsche Newsroom](#)) both predate this week; Traton's strong order book (+44% Q2 intake, [VW Group](#)) is the bright spot of the trio.

Copper (QCQ6): COMEX copper touched an all-time high near \$6.90/lb Wednesday before retreating to ~\$6.5–6.7 on Friday, driven by the DRC concentrate-export ban and AI/grid demand ([Trading Economics](#)). Position note below — this contract is in its delivery month.

Small/mid-cap & special situations

Universal Entertainment (6425 JP) printed the group's ugliest number. Okada Manila Q2 adjusted segment EBITDA fell 71% y/y (GGR –14.7%, VIP tables –56%) ([IAG](#)) — with S&P and Fitch already at negative outlook ([GGRAsia](#)), rating follow-through is a live risk.

RS Technologies (3445 JP) is a momentum powder keg into Wednesday. Up ~68% in 30 days and ~131% in a year on the fab-utilization → test-wafer-reclaim thesis ([Yahoo/Simply Wall St](#)); Q2 results land ~Aug 12 ([MarketScreener](#)) with beat-and-raise now effectively required.

Lion Finance (LIO LN) reports 1H on Tuesday Aug 11 with a call and likely capital-return news, following the completed GEL 55m buyback and treasury-share cancellations ([Investegate](#), [TipRanks](#)). One housekeeping note: live sources (LSE, Bloomberg) still show the ticker as **BGEO LN** ([LSE](#)) — worth verifying the LIO mapping in your system.

Jupiter (JUP LN) is quietly executing a re-rating. This week was mechanics — buyback trimmed the count to 518.1m ([Globe & Mail](#)), interim dividend record date passed Aug 7 — on the back of the H1 blowout (AUM +36% to £73.7bn with CCLA, underlying PBT +67% — [Investing.com](#)).

Impax (IPX LN) — quiet week, but your peer study is timely. No RNS Aug 2–9 ([Investegate](#)). The last datapoint (Q3 AUM £23.3bn, +4.4% in the quarter, most strategies outperforming, flows improving from the largest distribution partner — [Investegate](#)) supports a "stabilizing, not broken" read. In a week when Jupiter re-rated on flow recovery plus M&A synergies, Impax remains the obvious sub-scale consolidation candidate — though no live bid exists. Next hard datapoint is the FY AUM update in October.

Northern Dynasty (NAK) is a coiled binary. The stock slipped 3.4% Thursday on no news ([Kalkine](#)); the Alaska federal court ruling on the EPA 404(c) veto (argued June 25) can land any day with no warning ([StockTitan](#)). Size the position for a gap in either direction.

Graphite One (GPH CN / GPH-WA) — check which warrant series you hold, today. The Series A warrants (GPH.WT.A) carry a C\$2.25 strike and Feb 2029 expiry ([Newswire](#)), but the older GPH.WT series shows an **August 8, 2026 date on TradingView** ([TradingView](#)) — if the position is the old series, the expiry question is immediate. Background risk: the July switch from

Environmental Assessment to a full EIS lengthens permitting tail risk even though the company maintains its 2029 startup ([PR Newswire](#)).

Dingdong (DDL) has a hard cash date. Following the \$717M sale of China ops to Meituan, the company is due up to a further \$280M **before Aug 31** (~\$997M total) and intends to deploy a substantial majority ([SEC 6-K](#)); Q2 earnings Aug 20 should detail the capital-return plan ([Investing.com](#)).

Also in this group: European Lithium (EULIF) is now effectively a CRML stub at the 0.035x scheme ratio — CRML's +30% week mechanically repriced it, and the Scheme Booklet may land any day ([Proactive](#)). Vizsla (VZLA) rode silver and added Panuco execution leadership ([TipRanks](#)). Dai Nippon Printing (7912) posted a clean operating beat (OP +21.3%; the -48% net line is a prior-year base effect, not deterioration — [TipRanks](#)); TOPPAN (7911) reports Aug 12. SMH LN rebounded with the sector (semi ETFs topped all ETF weekly inflows — [Yahoo](#)); one piece worth reading argues the capped-weight SOXX is beating SMH by ~20pts YTD purely on lower Nvidia concentration ([24/7 Wall St](#)). Bukalapak, Cadiz, and DiDi were quiet (Cadiz reports ~Aug 13-14, DiDi ~Aug 27).

Futures / macro hedges

Beyond the top-of-stack macro story: **FTSE (Z U6)** rose 1.2% to a fresh all-time high intraweek, closing 10,910 Friday ([Trading Economics](#)) against the backdrop of July's hawkish 6-3 BoE hold ([CNBC](#)). **High yield (HYG)**: spreads at 271bp are in the richest decile of history ([Convex/FRED](#)) — the hedge is cheap to hold but there's no margin of safety in credit if CPI surprises hot. **Uranium (UXQ6)**: spot flat at ~\$86.50/lb, +20% y/y, in a consolidation after the speculative run; supply cuts (Cameco, Kazatomprom) and AI power demand underpin ([Trading Economics](#)). **Treasury supply next week is the event**: \$125B refunding — 3y Tuesday, 10y Wednesday (CPI day), 30y Thursday (PPI day) ([US Treasury](#)).

*Identification note: I could not confirm what **YBYU6** is — the closest matches are in the ASX rates complex (YT 3-year bond futures; YBA bank-bill chain codes), but nothing verifiable maps to "YBY". Please confirm the instrument. Similarly, **EP059897 Pfd** appears to be a Bloomberg internal preferred-security identifier that I could not resolve to an issuer — happy to chase it down with more detail.*

US large-cap core

Palantir (PLTR) delivered the week's biggest single-stock event anywhere in the book: Q2 revenue \$1.94B, +92.8% y/y (\$123M beat), US commercial +149%, FY guide raised ~\$498M to \$8.15B ([CNBC](#), [TradingKey](#)); the stock ran ~+30% to ~\$163, squeezing an estimated \$3B from shorts ([TechTimes](#)). The uncomfortable part: it now trades ~43x projected 2026 *sales* ([24/7 Wall St](#)). Consider whether the position's weight has drifted beyond intent.

Caterpillar (CAT) posted its first-ever \$20B+ quarter: revenue +24%, adj. EPS \$8.17 (+73%), backlog \$72B (+92% y/y) with orders stretching to 2030 on the power-generation/AI-datacenter cycle; FY outlook raised to mid-to-high-teens growth ([PR Newswire](#)). Tariff cost

estimates came down (\$400M in Q2 vs \$700M prior expectation, with \$392M of IEEPA recoveries booked — [TheStreet](#)).

Eli Lilly (LLY) beat and raised again: revenue \$22.97B (+48%), Mounjaro \$9.9B (+91%), Zepbound \$4.9B; FY26 revenue guide up to \$85–87B; the oral GLP-1 (orforglipron, now branded **Foundayo**, approved April) posted \$98M in its first real launch quarter ([Lilly IR](#), [Benzinga](#)). Foundayo's script trajectory is now the number to watch.

The rest: Costco July comps +8.9% (+6.6% ex-gas/FX), e-commerce +17.7% — strong but routine ([Costco IR](#)). IBKR July DARTs +27% y/y but –16% m/m (summer seasonality; record 5.32M accounts — [Business Wire](#)). Tapestry sits near record highs (~\$161) with pre-earnings target raises (JPMorgan to \$211 — [StockAnalysis](#)) ahead of Thursday's FY print. Walmart is quiet until Aug 20. MAGS had a strong beta week (Nvidia +11.6%) but the basket's internal dispersion — Apple leading ~+23% YTD, group as a whole trailing the S&P — remains the real story ([CNBC](#)).

3. Probably noise

- **UNP's drift to four-week lows** ([Trading Economics](#)) — no event behind it; the STB schedule order is what will actually move the pair.
 - **LVMH/Dior administrative filings** (buyback and voting-rights disclosures) — routine; nothing changes until October Q3 revenue.
 - **Industrivärden's monthly NAV** (SEK 523/share at July 31 — [Industrivärden](#)) — routine print; the ongoing Volvo/Handelsbanken accumulation is background.
 - **Naspers/Prosus weekly buyback disclosures and the eMAG clearance** — mechanical; Tencent Wednesday is all that matters.
 - **TOPPAN's post-quantum-cryptography card launch** ([TOPPAN](#)) — strategic PR targeting FY2027; no near-term P&L.
 - **ZIM's La Guaira port resumption and Zacks-rank commentary** — the stock is deal-pinned; freight-rate news no longer drives it.
 - **IBKR's m/m DART decline** — summer seasonality on top of +27% y/y growth.
 - **Costco's July sales** — strong, consistent, and fully expected; note gas inflation added ~2.9pts to comps.
 - **Genting Malaysia scholarship program, Samsung C&T fashion pop-ups, Vizsla's Chief Geologist transition** — housekeeping.
 - **Post-H1 analyst target tinkering on Puig, Ferrari, Tapestry** — directionally interesting, not decision-grade on its own.
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4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

Option/derivative positions:

- **CRML 08/21/26 \$12.50 call — 9 trading days to expiry, ~42% OTM.** Decision this week: hold for a Tanbreez/policy lottery ticket or harvest any remaining premium on spikes. (Sources in §1.)
- **QCQ6 (E-mini copper, Aug 2026) — this is the delivery month.** The QC contract is thin at the best of times; with copper having just made an all-time high and pulled back, roll or close ahead of delivery mechanics rather than into them ([CME](#), [Trading Economics](#)).
- **UXQ6 (UxC uranium, Aug 2026) —** also an August contract; confirm roll intentions ([CME](#)).
- **GPH-WA warrants — verify series immediately.** If the holding is old-series GPH.WT rather than GPH.WT.A, the listed date is Aug 8, 2026 ([TradingView](#)).

Calendar (all dates 2026):

Date	Event
Mon Aug 10	AITi Global Q2 (after close); Blackstone \$1.29 dividend paid
Tue Aug 11	Lion Finance 1H results + call; US 3-year auction (\$58B)
Wed Aug 12	US July CPI (8:30am ET) + 10-year auction (\$42B); Tencent Q2 (Naspers/Prosus); RS Technologies Q2; TOPPAN Q1
Thu Aug 13	US July PPI + 30-year auction (\$25B); PSH/PSUS semiannuals + Pershing Square Inc. Q2 + Ackman Q&A; Tapestry FY26 Q4 (pre-market) ; Genting Singapore H1; Sanken Electric Q1; Cadiz Q2 (or Aug 14)
Tue Aug 18	Northern Dynasty Q2 (approx.)
Wed Aug 19	ZIM Q2 (pre-market, no call; possible interim dividend); SK Inc. Q2
Thu Aug 20	Coty FY Q4 (after close) ; Dingdong Q2; Walmart Q2 FY27
Fri Aug 21	CRML \$12.50 call expiry
Wed Aug 26	Nvidia FQ2 — sector verdict for Samsung/SK Hynix/SMH/NQ
Thu-Sat Aug 27-29	Jackson Hole (Warsh speech = Sept FOMC setup)
Mon Aug 31	Dingdong \$280M cash-receipt deadline; UNP dividend record date

Undated but live: STB procedural-schedule order (UNP/NSC); DE/NY/MA insurance approvals (BHF, outside date Sept 6); Alaska court ruling (NAK); Hormuz deal ratification (ENI/REP/TTE, silver, equities broadly); Kurmuk first gold (AAUC); EULIF Scheme Booklet dispatch; Austria/Spain/EU decisions on Ceconomy.

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

1. **CRML:** Is there any bid in the Aug \$12.50 calls at all, and does rolling the thesis into September/October strikes (or the EULIF stub, which trades at the 0.035x ratio) offer better risk-reward than expiry roulette? What exactly does the Tanbreez "Stage 1 pilot plant completion" milestone contain, and has the EXIM \$120M LOI progressed toward a binding facility?
2. **SK Hynix / Samsung pair:** After a 13–15% Hynix drawdown on no news, is the right move adding — or does the Counterpoint data showing Micron within ~1ppt of Hynix's DRAM revenue share ([KuCoin/Counterpoint](#)) plus Samsung's projected 2027 HBM share lead signal the moat is narrowing at peak margins (76%)? What do the 2027 HBM contract negotiations imply for pricing?
3. **Rates positioning into Wednesday/Thursday:** With September hike odds at 42% and CPI/PPI landing on top of the 10y/30y auctions, is the WNU6/IEF long the right expression if inflation prints hot in a hiking-Fed regime? What's the plan if the 30-year re-tests the July auction high of 5.06%+?
4. **BHF:** What is the actual status and typical timeline of the Delaware, New York, and Massachusetts insurance reviews? NY DFS is historically the slow one — is the spread to \$70 pricing a Sept 6 close or a Dec 6 close?
5. **Energy sleeve vs. Hormuz:** If the Iran-Oman deal is ratified, how much of ENI/REP/TTE's 2026 consensus EPS is attributable to crisis-elevated realizations, and do the buyback programs (€3.4bn Eni, €500m Repsol) hold at \$75 Brent?
6. **Impax:** Post-IEM tender, what is the run-rate AUM excluding one-offs, and does the Jupiter/CCLA playbook (consolidation + synergies driving a 67% PBT jump) make IPX more likely a buyer, a target, or neither? Your peer study's October FY AUM update is the next checkpoint.
7. **PLTR / MAGS concentration:** After a +30% week, what is Palantir's weight in the portfolio now, and does combined AI-complex exposure (PLTR + MAGS + SMH + Samsung/Hynix + NQ futures) exceed what you'd deliberately choose as a single correlated bet on Nvidia's Aug 26 print?
8. **Housekeeping:** What are YBYU6 and EP059897 Pfd? (Unresolvable from the codes alone — see §2.) And confirm the GPH warrant series and the LIO/BGEO ticker mapping.

Prepared Aug 9, 2026. All links verified via live search this week; two identifiers (YBYU6, EP059897) could not be confirmed and are flagged above. Sister-listing note: IPRV LN appears twice in the source list (same fund); ITP FP consolidates into IPAR US.